effective ultimately requires UNSC reform. The UNSC features five permanent veto-wielding members—the United States, Russia, China, United Kingdom and France (or P-5)—representing the victors of World War II and their successor entities.

To this end, India has been consistently advocating for its own permanent membership in the UNSC as well as better representation overall for other countries, including those of the Global South. There are past precedents for UNSC reform, including the addition of non-permanent members in the 1960s as well as expansion of the UN Economic and Social Council. India has been part of the G-4 (along with Germany, Japan and Brazil) advocating for their group's permanent membership, as well as two more permanent members from Africa. This might initially involve membership for India without a veto, subject to a later review following a specific timeframe. India is also part of a group within the UN called the L.69 Group, involving mostly developing states, which has advocated for more radical reform.

But such efforts have faced resistance from many quarters. A group called United for Consensus (or informally the Coffee Club) includes Pakistan and resists expansion of permanent membership. The Africa Group at the UN remains hesitant about proposing how it would fill its seats should expansion of permanent members take place. Although four of P-5 have agreed in principle to new permanent and non-permanent members (while doing little to facilitate the process), China alone has not voiced support. Ironically, the greatest obstacle to better representation for Asia and the Global South at the UNSC comes from its sole Asian member. For all these reasons, the formal negotiations over the UNSC reform have stalled since 2015, with little movement on details, timeframes or record of proceedings.

India will have to continue advocating for representation and hold the process more to account, including by building the coalition for reform. Various compromises by the numerous negotiating parties might well be necessary, such as on geographical representation or the veto. But a formula could theoretically be worked out that would make the UNSC— and by extension UN governance—more representative and effective. An absence